BOOKLIST

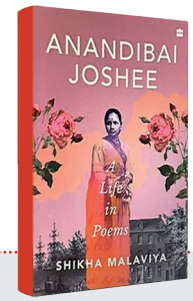
Cadence of Our Times

POEMS, HYMNS AND *DOHAS* ADORN THESE SEMINAL BOOKS OF VERSE

BEHOLD! THE WORD IS GOD

Hymns of Tukaram
Translated by **Shanta Gokhale** and **Jerry Pinto**
SPEAKING TIGER
₹350; 128 pages

This is a selection of 51 *abhangas* or devotional poems composed in Marathi by the 17th-century Bhakti saint Tukaram, who was a devotee of Vithoba, an avatar of Vishnu. In an interesting approach, each of the *abhangas* has been translated by both Shanta Gokhale and Jerry Pinto, and the translations appear one after the other, and after the original Marathi in Roman transliteration. For instance, "*Aaamhaa ghar dhana shabdaanchicha ratne*" is translated by Shanta Gokhale as "Words are the jewels that fill our homes", while Jerry Pinto's rendition reads: "Words, our wealth."



ANANDIBAI JOSHEE: A LIFE IN POEMS

by Shikha Malaviya
HARPERCOLLINS
₹399; 136 pages

Anandibai Joshee (1865-87) was India's first female physician and also, it seems, the first Indian woman to travel to the United States to pursue an education. In this extraordinarily unusual book of poems, based in part on Joshee's letters, her life is reimagined in verse by Shikha Malaviya, a writer based in the San Francisco Bay area. Malaviya decided to write these 'historical persona poems' while researching a long lyric poem on the racism she had experienced while growing up in Minnesota in the early 1980s.

THE WHITE SHIRTS OF SUMMER

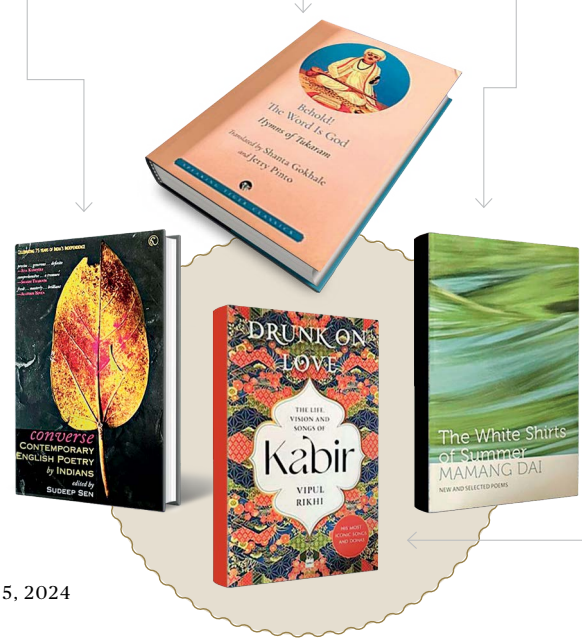
New and Selected Poems
By Mamang Dai
SPEAKING TIGER
₹399; 104 pages

A major literary voice from the Northeast and a much celebrated writer and poet, Mamang Dai won the Sahitya Akademi Award in 2017 for her novel, *The Black Hill*. Arundhati Subramaniam states in the jacket blurb: "Dai's poetic world is one of river, forest and mountain, a limpid and lyrical reflection of the terrain of her home state [Arunachal Pradesh]." In this new book of poems, Dai's writing is direct, shorn of superfluity. On the Covid-19 pandemic, she muses: "Our fragility is no match for this second wave./ Again, this uproar of war and warriors."

CONVERSE

Contemporary English Poetry by Indians
Edited by Sudeep Sen
PIPPA RANN BOOKS
₹899; 616 pages

This wide-ranging anthology of poems in English is penned by contemporary writers drawn from India as well as the Indian diaspora. It is edited by Sudeep Sen, an international prize-winning poet himself, as well as translator and literary editor. Naturally, this makes for a large volume in small type. Both Jayanta Mahapatra and Gieve Patel have made it into the anthology since it was published before their passing. Names that pop out include R. Parthasarathy, Adil Jussawala, Naveen Kishore, Mamang Dai, C.P. Surendran, Mustansir Dalvi, Kynpham Sing Nongkynrih, Tabish Khair, among others.



DRUNK ON LOVE

The Life, Vision and Songs of Kabir
by Vipul Rikhi
HARPERCOLLINS
₹499; 308 pages

For lovers of Kabir and his syncretic verse, this book is a treasure trove. Besides scholarly chapters that introduce the life and work of the mystic poet, 60 'iconic songs' of his have been published in English in this book. There is also a selection of *dohas* (couplets) as well as the original songs in Roman script. Of course, many different versions of Kabir's songs and *dohas* exist in both oral tradition and textual form. Rikhi has gone with the version he was personally attracted to. "Like all extant Kabirs, my Kabir too is a personal one," he writes.

–Amit Dixit